

A PARENT'S GUIDE

Dyscalculia & Maths Confidence

Understanding why numbers are hard, and how to help your child feel capable again.



If your child finds maths genuinely hard, it isn't a sign of low intelligence or laziness. Around one in twenty children has dyscalculia, a real difference in how the brain understands numbers, and many more simply hit a wall at one tricky concept. The good news: with the right, patient support, numbers can start to make sense, and confidence can come back.

Signs you might recognise

- ✓ Counts on fingers long after other children have stopped
- ✓ Struggles to recall facts like $6 + 7$ or times tables
- ✓ Loses track of the steps in a longer sum
- ✓ Finds time, money, or estimating distance confusing
- ✓ Feels anxious, tearful, or shuts down at maths time
- ✓ Can talk well but freezes when numbers appear

What you can do at home

- **Make numbers something they can touch.** Count real objects, Lego, buttons or snacks. Seeing and moving quantities builds the 'number sense' that worksheets can't.
- **Cook and shop together.** Measuring, weighing, doubling a recipe and counting change turn maths into something real and low-pressure.
- **Play dice and domino games.** Spotting how many dots without counting (subitising) is one of the strongest foundations for maths.
- **Talk maths out loud.** Narrate everyday sums: 'I have 3, I need 5, how many more?' Hearing the thinking helps it stick.
- **Take the timer away.** Speed drills raise anxiety. Aim for understanding first; let your child use fingers and tools without shame.

- **Protect their confidence.** Never say 'it's easy'. Praise effort and strategy, not speed, and notice every small win.

Little and often beats long and stressful. Ten calm minutes a day is plenty.

When it's worth seeking support

Consider reaching out if, over time, you notice:

- › A gap that stays or grows despite real effort
- › Rising anxiety, tears or avoidance around maths
- › Your child starting to say 'I'm just bad at maths'
- › Basic number facts that never seem to stick

How The Lodestone Centre can help

We start by understanding how your child thinks (an optional screening), then rebuild number sense from solid foundations using multi-sensory, visual methods, at their pace, in small groups. Confidence comes before correctness.

Programs that often help: Math Program, Screening, Progressive Coding, IGCSE Crash Course, Lodestone Evo (early years).

Free 15-minute call · WhatsApp 012-212 7743 · thelodestonesolution.com

This guide is for general information and to support parents. The Lodestone Centre provides educational support, screening and programs; it is not a substitute for formal schooling or a clinical diagnosis. If you have concerns about your child's development, a screening or a chat with our team is a good next step.